Flag 1.

Using the Terminal

21 hacking, 40613 solves

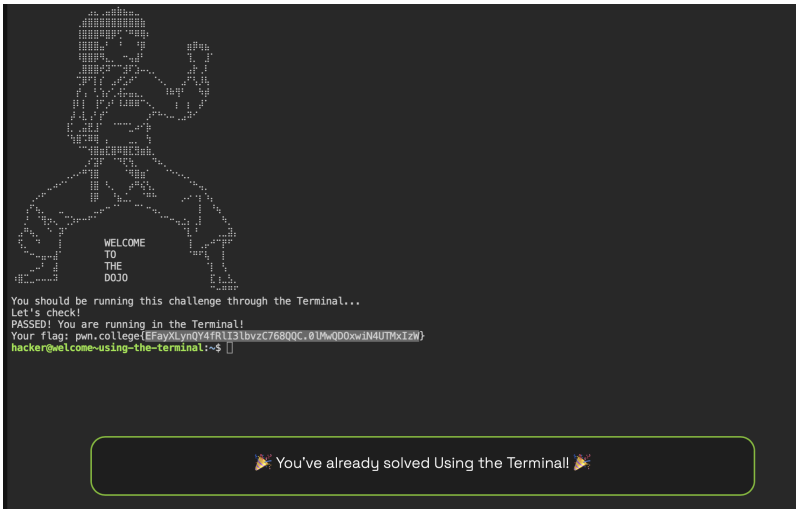
Throughout your pwn.college journey, you will have countless interactions with the Linux terminal, colloquially termed the "shell". If you don't yet know the Art of the Shell, fear not, you will! For now, we'll just focus on *launching* it.

We make launching the terminal easy: when you start a challenge, we do it for you! Just click ▶ `Start` below, and this challenge will start. Once it's loaded, the terminal will appear automatically right under this text, and you will be granted your first flag!

Flag? As a reminder, this platform uses flags to track your progress. Flags are cryptographic tokens that are given to you when you solve challenges. Once you see it, copy-paste it into the submission box below and submit! Then, once you get the confirmation that the flag was correct, move on to the next challenge!

Try it now: launch the terminal, copy the flag (drag-selecting it with your mouse will automatically copy it to your clipboard), and paste it into the `Flag` textbox below!





Using the VSCode Workspace

20 hacking, 54503 solves

This challenge will teach you to use the Visual Studio Code workspace. You can start this challenge using the Start button below. When it starts, you'll probably see the Terminal, like the previous level. This time, though, the challenge will refuse to give you the flag until you switch to vscode!

You can use the workspace selector on the bar below the Terminal (e.g., the button that says "Terminal") to select "Code" and bring up the Visual Studio Code interface in place of the terminal. Again, you can use it as-is, or you can click the "fullscreen" button (⛶) to full-screen the interface for more room.

Once VSCode loads, launch a terminal (press `Control-Shift-Backtick` or click the ≡ button in VSCode's left panel, and select the Terminal menu, and click New Terminal). When we detect that you have launched the terminal in VSCode, we will give you the flag!



Flag 2.

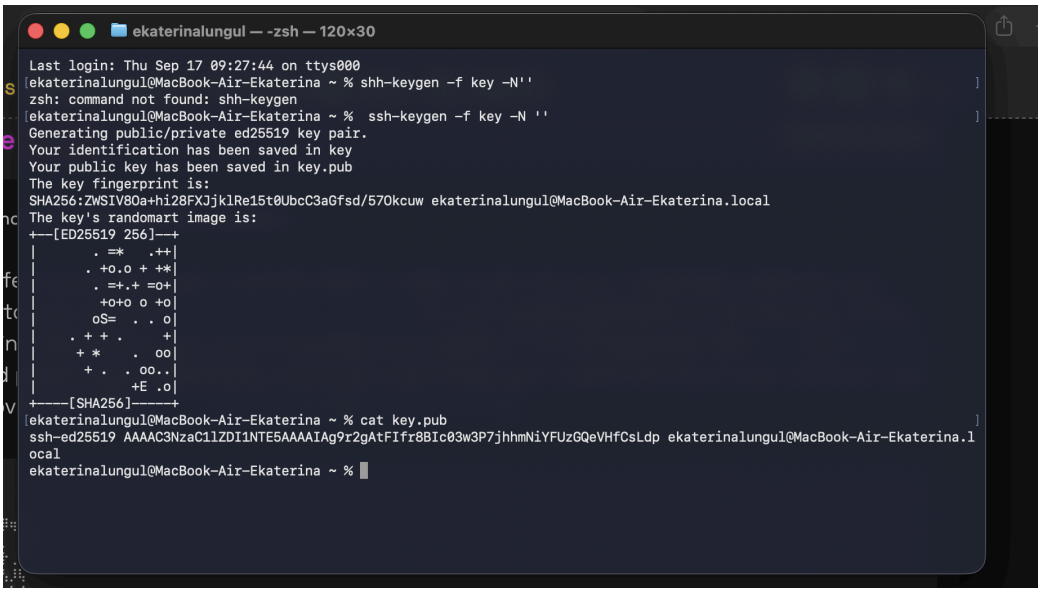
Connecting over SSH

17 hacking, 0 solves

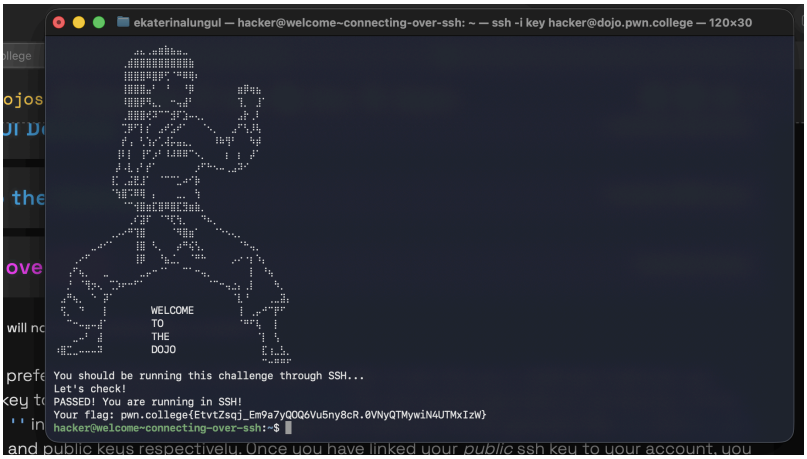
This challenge is optional, it will not count towards dojo completion.

Advanced users often prefer connecting over a remote shell. In order to ssh into your challenge instances, you must link a public ssh key to your account through your settings. You can quickly generate an ssh key by running `ssh-keygen -f key -N ''` in a terminal on your (unix-friendly) host machine. This will generate files `key` and `key.pub`, which are your private and public keys respectively. Once you have linked your *public* ssh key to your account, you can connect to the dojo over ssh with `ssh -i key hacker@dojo.pwn.college`.

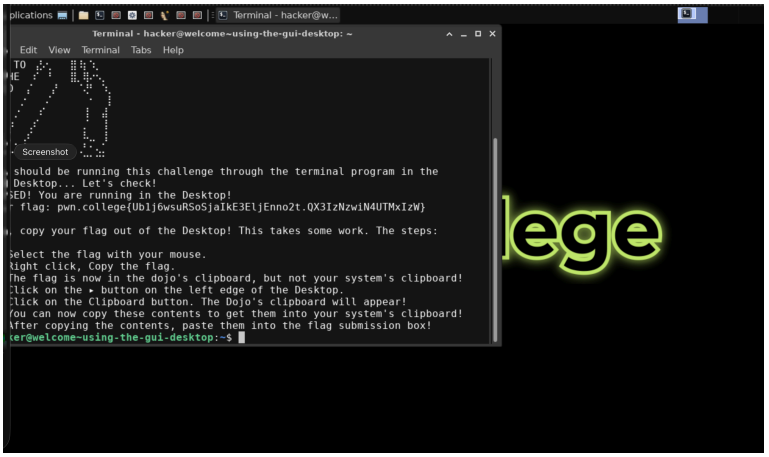
Flag 3.

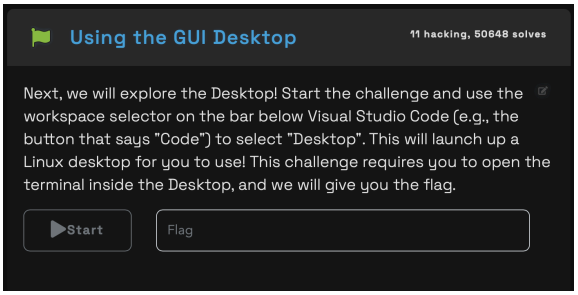


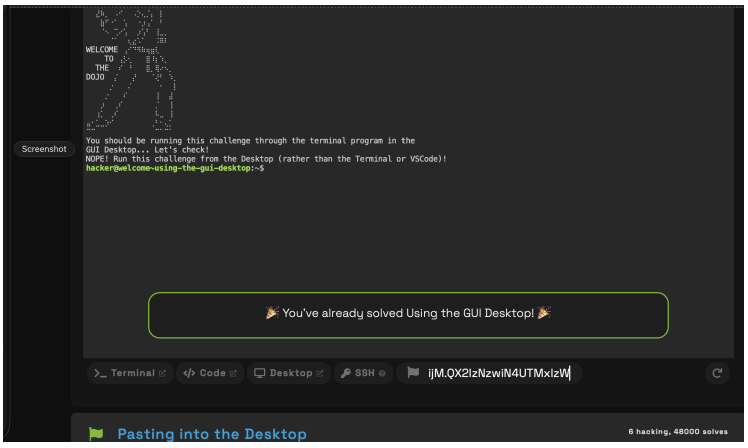


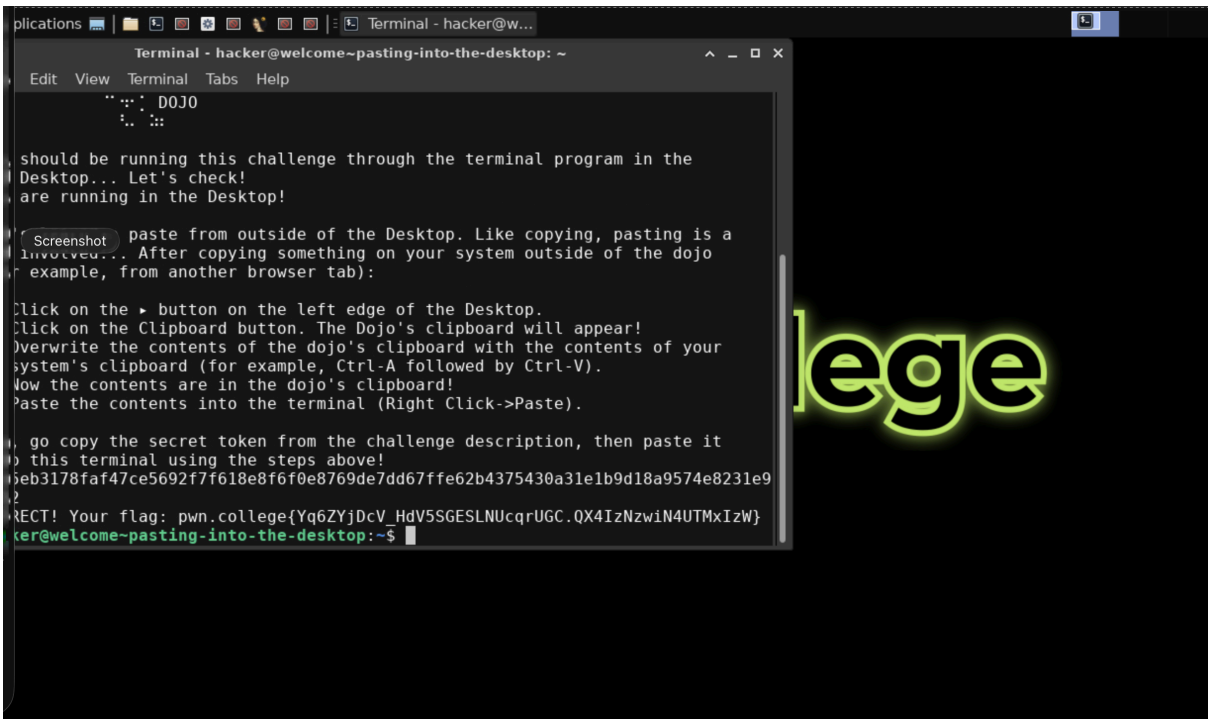


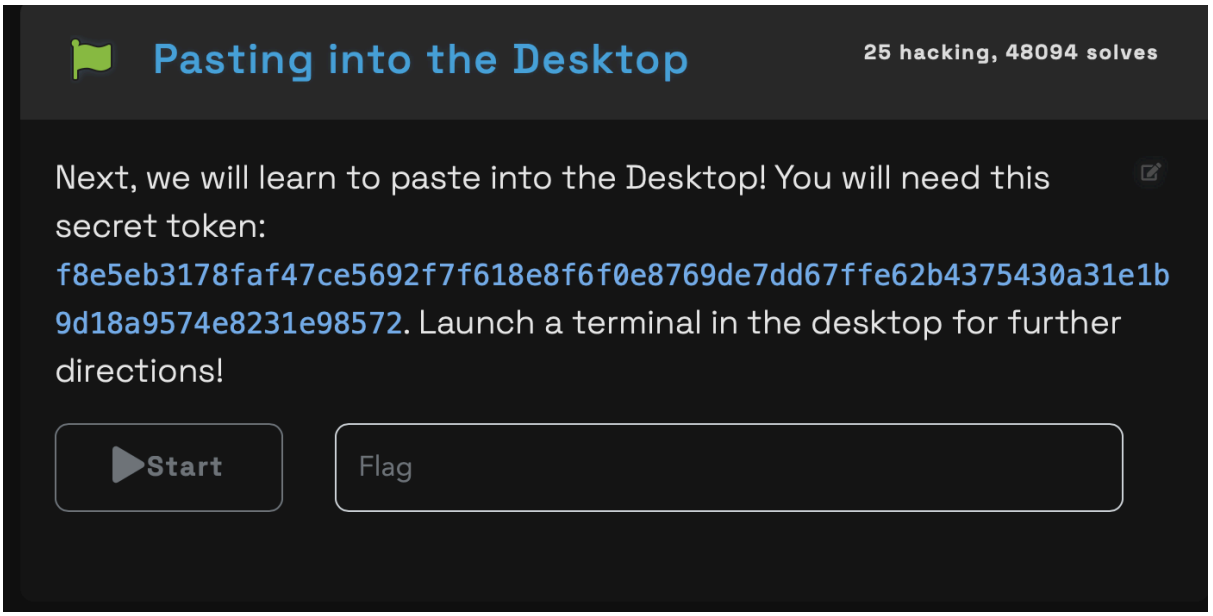
and public keys respectively. Once you have linked your *public* ssh key to your account, you





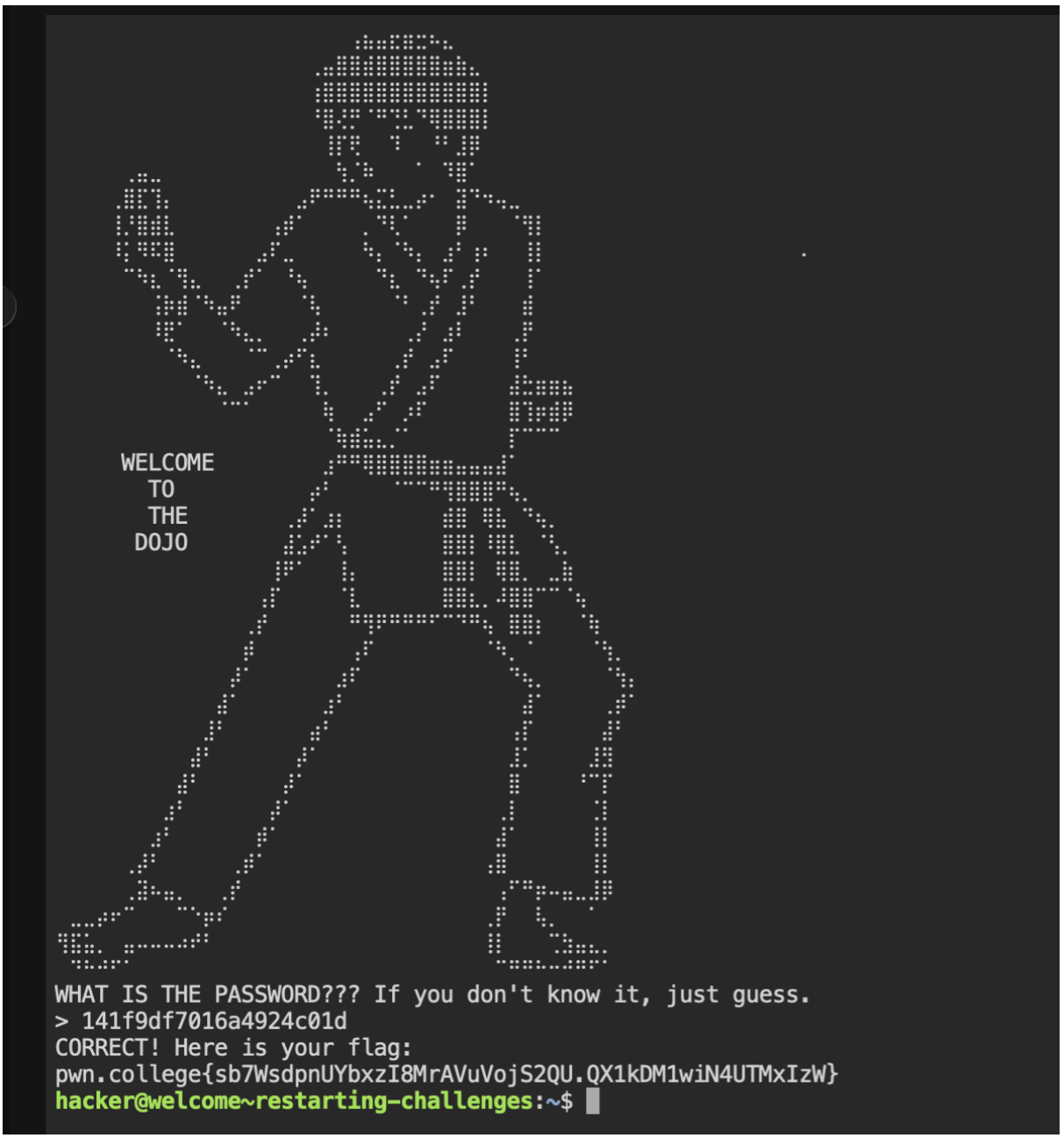



Terminal - hacker@w...
Terminal - hacker@welcome~pasting-into-the-desktop: ~
Edit View Terminal Tabs Help
DOJO
should be running this challenge through the terminal program in the
Desktop... Let's check!
are running in the Desktop!
Screenshot
paste from outside of the Desktop. Like copying, pasting is a
After copying something on your system outside of the dojo
example, from another browser tab):
Click on the ▸ button on the left edge of the Desktop.
Click on the Clipboard button. The Dojo's clipboard will appear!
Overwrite the contents of the dojo's clipboard with the contents of your
system's clipboard (for example, Ctrl-A followed by Ctrl-V).
Now the contents are in the dojo's clipboard!
Paste the contents into the terminal (Right Click->Paste).
go copy the secret token from the challenge description, then paste it
this terminal using the steps above!
f8e5eb3178faf47ce5692f7f618e8f6f0e8769de7dd67ffe62b4375430a31e1b9d18a9574e8231e9
RECT! Your flag: pwn.college{Yq6ZYjDcV_HdV5SGESLNUcqrUGC.QX4IzNzwiN4UTMxIzW}
ker@welcome~pasting-into-the-desktop:~$
lege


Pasting into the Desktop
25 hacking, 48094 solves
Next, we will learn to paste into the Desktop! You will need this secret token: f8e5eb3178faf47ce5692f7f618e8f6f0e8769de7dd67ffe62b4375430a31e1b9d18a9574e8231e98572. Launch a terminal in the desktop for further directions!
Start
Flag


WELCOME
THE
TO
DOJO
Screenshot
You should be running this challenge through the terminal program in the
GUI Desktop... Let's check!
NOPE! Run this challenge from the Desktop (rather than VSCode or SSH)!
hacker@welcome~pasting-into-the-desktop:~$
🎉 You've already solved Pasting into the Desktop! 🎉
Terminal
Code
Desktop
SSH
b9d18a9574e8231e98572

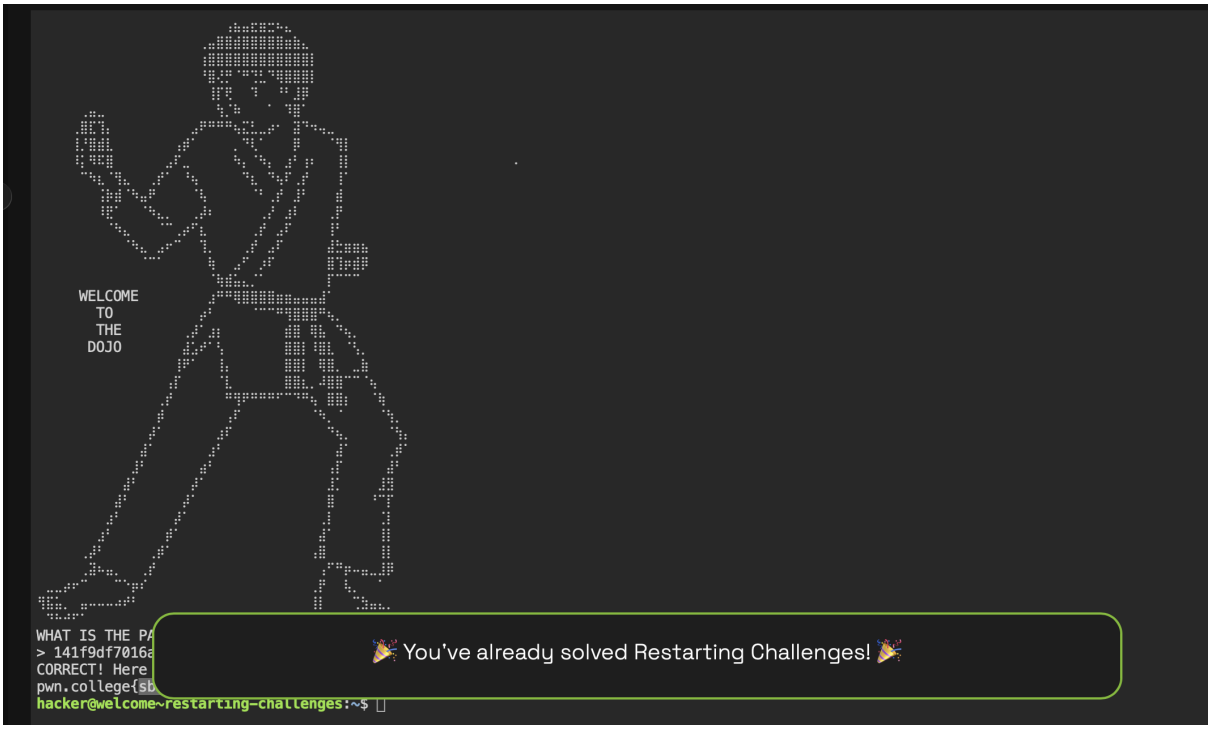

Screenshot
WELCOME
TO
THE
DOJO
IS THE PASSWORD??? If you don't know it, just guess.
fshchhohjfo
RRECT! The right password is '141f9df7016a4924c01d'.
challenge will now delete the flag.
art it to try again, and use the correct '141f9df7016a4924c01d' password!
er@welcome~restarting-challenges:~$




```
WHAT IS THE PASSWORD??? If you don't know it, just guess.
> 141f9df7016a4924c01d
CORRECT! Here is your flag:
pwn.college{sb7WsdpnUYbxzI8MrAVuVojS2QU.QX1kDM1wiN4UTMxIzW}
hacker@welcome~restarting-challenges:~$
```

Interacting with the Dojo

Getting Started	
Using the Terminal	22 hacking, 40500 solves
Using the VSCode Workspace	13 hacking, 54406 solves
Using the GUI Desktop	7 hacking, 50556 solves
Pasting into the Desktop	7 hacking, 48012 solves
Connecting over SSH	7 hacking, 0 solves
Restarting Challenges	7 hacking, 42231 solves
Getting Help	8 hacking, 0 solves



Getting Help

7 hacking, 0 solves

This challenge is optional, it will not count towards dojo completion.

The challenges in pwn.college can be tricky and, oftentimes, you might get stuck! There are several ways to get yourself unstuck:

1. Think for a long time. This will reinforce knowledge and build experience that will help you think through future problems!
2. Search online for help. This is a critical skill, and you will need to develop it over the course of working through pwn.college.
3. Ask for help.

There are two resources to ask for help. The first is our discord, full of amazing hackers who are willing to help with trickier issues. But for many typical issues you will run into, there is SENSAI, your AI-powered sensei for the dojo.

SENSAI is an LLM that is augmented with information about the challenge, common issues people run into with the challenge, and your actual terminal and filesystem state. This means that it can be an effective help for many issues, and can help bridge knowledge gaps that might be hampering your progress!

This challenge will force you to interact with SENSAI. SENSAI can be accessed through the Help link in the navigation bar at the top of the page! Access it only *after* launching the challenge: if you ask SENSAI for help before that, it will just tell you to open the terminal so that the challenge can launch!

how do i get the flag of this challenge ?

For **this specific intro challenge**, the password is:

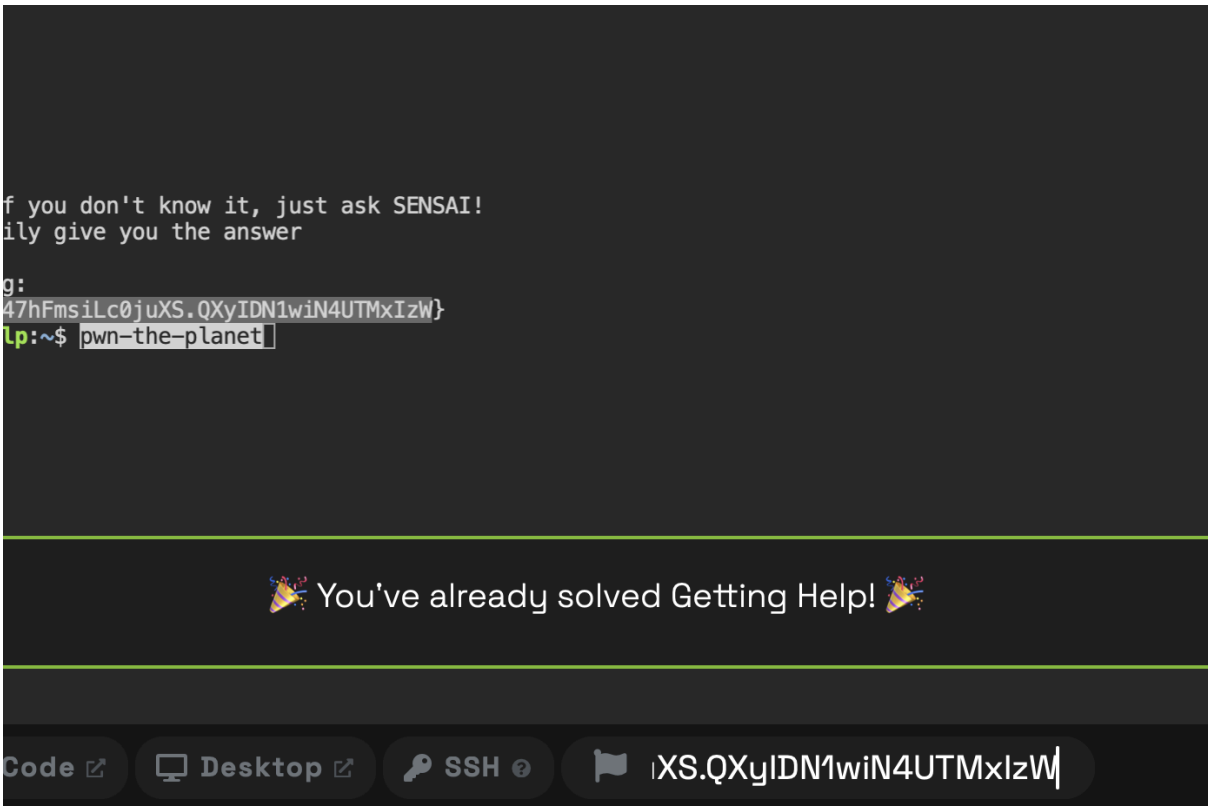
```
pwn-the-planet
```

Use that where the challenge asks for it, and you should be able to proceed.

Nice start — keep going with pwn.college!



```
WHAT IS THE PASSWORD??? If you don't know it, just ask SENSAI!
Don't worry, it will happily give you the answer
> pwn-the-planet
CORRECT! Here is your flag:
pwn.college{cR_hcKXh2AgP147hFmsiLc0juXS.QXyIDN1wiN4UTMxIzW}
hacker@welcome~getting-help:~$
```



```
f you don't know it, just ask SENSAI!
ily give you the answer

g:
47hFmsiLc0juXS.QXyIDN1wiN4UTMxIzW}
lp:~$ pwn-the-planet
```

🎉 You've already solved Getting Help! 🎉

Code Desktop SSH XS.QXyIDN1wiN4UTMxIzW

```
er@welcome~challenge-programs:~$ /challenge
: /challenge: Is a directory
er@welcome~challenge-programs:~$ /challenge/solve
```



```
  THE
  DOJO

.....
ratulations! Your flag is:
college{USR0EOGSc4QCVZoC7X0vX0nxWSs.QX0MDO0wiN4UTMxIzW}
er@welcome~challenge-programs:~$
```

Screenshot

🎉 You've already solved Challenge Programs! 🎉

The Challenge Environment

HACKER BEWARE! The challenges below assume that you are familiar with the basics of the Linux commandline. If you are not, don't worry! Simply do our Linux Luminarium first, then come back and do these challenges!

Challenge Programs

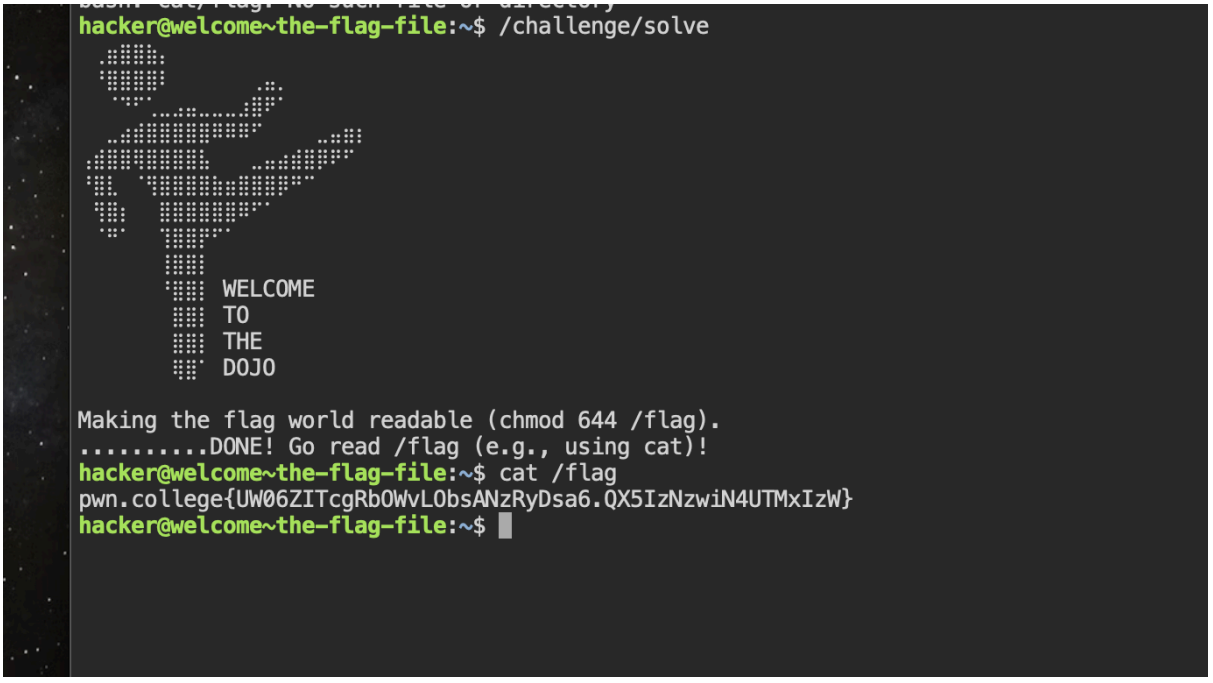
10 hacking, 35569 solves

The actual files comprising the challenge live in the `/challenge` directory. Unlike previous challenges, which automatically ran when the terminal was opened, this challenge requires you to invoke the `/challenge/solve` program directly! Just by running it in a terminal, you will get the flag!

NOTE: This challenge, and the challenges below, begin to assume that you possess knowledge of the Linux commandline. If you happen to lack this knowledge, we recommend you to first complete the Linux Luminarium dojo, then resume this module!

Start

Flag



🎉 You've already solved The Flag File! 🎉

The Flag File

7 hacking, 36578 solves

So far, the challenges have been giving you flags directly. In this challenge, you will learn that the flag actually lives in the `/flag` file. Your real goal, in any challenge, is to get the contents of this file through any means necessary, even if the challenge program does not do it on purpose.

You might try to just read the `/flag` file on your own. Unfortunately for you, you are executing as the `hacker` user and `/flag` is only readable by the `root` user, so you cannot access it. In the previous challenges, the challenge program itself (e.g., `/challenge/solve`), which runs as the `root` user (and, thus, can read the flag), read this file and printed its contents, but this level is harder.

Like many of the other challenges on the platform, this challenge's `/challenge/solve` program will not read the flag file directly. However, it will make the flag world-readable when you run it! After that, you will need to read `/flag` yourself (e.g., using `cat /flag` or a text editor), and submit its contents as the solution.

```
hacker@practice~welcome~using-privileged-mode:~$ sudo cat /challenge/secret
f8440e72b3a4ea48ff71530e2130ab4f847bcfda05d9d639b6692fd029abcace6f0fc28070256bda0f21
hacker@practice~welcome~using-privileged-mode:~$
```

```
hacker@welcome~using-privileged-mode:~$ /challenge/solve
  .:::::.          .::.
 ::::::::        .::::::.
 `::::'          ::::::' .:.
   .::.  WELCOME  `::' .::::.
 .::::::.   TO   .::::::::::::.
 ::::::::.      .::::'''''::::::.
 ::::::::::.  .::::'       `::::::
 `::`::::::::::::'          .::::'
   `::.`::::::::::::::::::::::::'
     `::::'    THE    .::::'
       ::::   DOJO  .::::'
       ::::        ::::'
       ::::        ::::
       `:::.      .:::'
         `:::.  .:::'
           `::::::'
             `::'

You are not running in Privileged mode! Hopefully, you have already run this
challenge in Privileged mode and used sudo to read /challenge/secret. If not,
restart this challenge in Privileged mode and do so, then come back to real
mode to try this again.

ENTER SECRET: f8440e72b3a4ea48ff71530e2130ab4f847bcfda05d9d639b6692fd029abcace6f0fc28070256bda0f21
CORRECT! Your flag: pwn.college{0lNCcSpPBLSxYqJAvuFQgDZB4-j.QXwMzNzwiN4UTMxIzW}
hacker@welcome~using-privileged-mode:~$
```

```
in Privileged mode and used sudo to read /challenge/secret. If not,
is challenge in Privileged mode and do so, then come back to real
y this again.

ET: f8440e72b3a4ea48ff71530e2130ab4f847bcfda05d9d639b6692fd029abcace6f0fc28070256bda0f21
our flag: pwn.college{0lNCcSpPBLSxYqJAvuFQgDZB4-j.QXwMzNzwiN4UTMxIzW}
come~using-privileged-mode:~$
```

🎉 You've already solved Using Privileged Mode! 🎉

Using Privileged Mode

5 hacking, 33396 solves

You can launch challenges in two modes, using the buttons below! So far, you have been using `Start`, which launches the challenge so that you can attempt to solve it for real. You can also start a challenge with the `Privileged` button! This will grant you administrative privileges (via `sudo`) in the challenge container, allowing you greater capabilities to debug solutions and otherwise experiment with the challenge. You cannot use this to actually solve the challenge because the `/flag` file, in privileged mode, is replaced with a "practice flag" that cannot be redeemed for points.

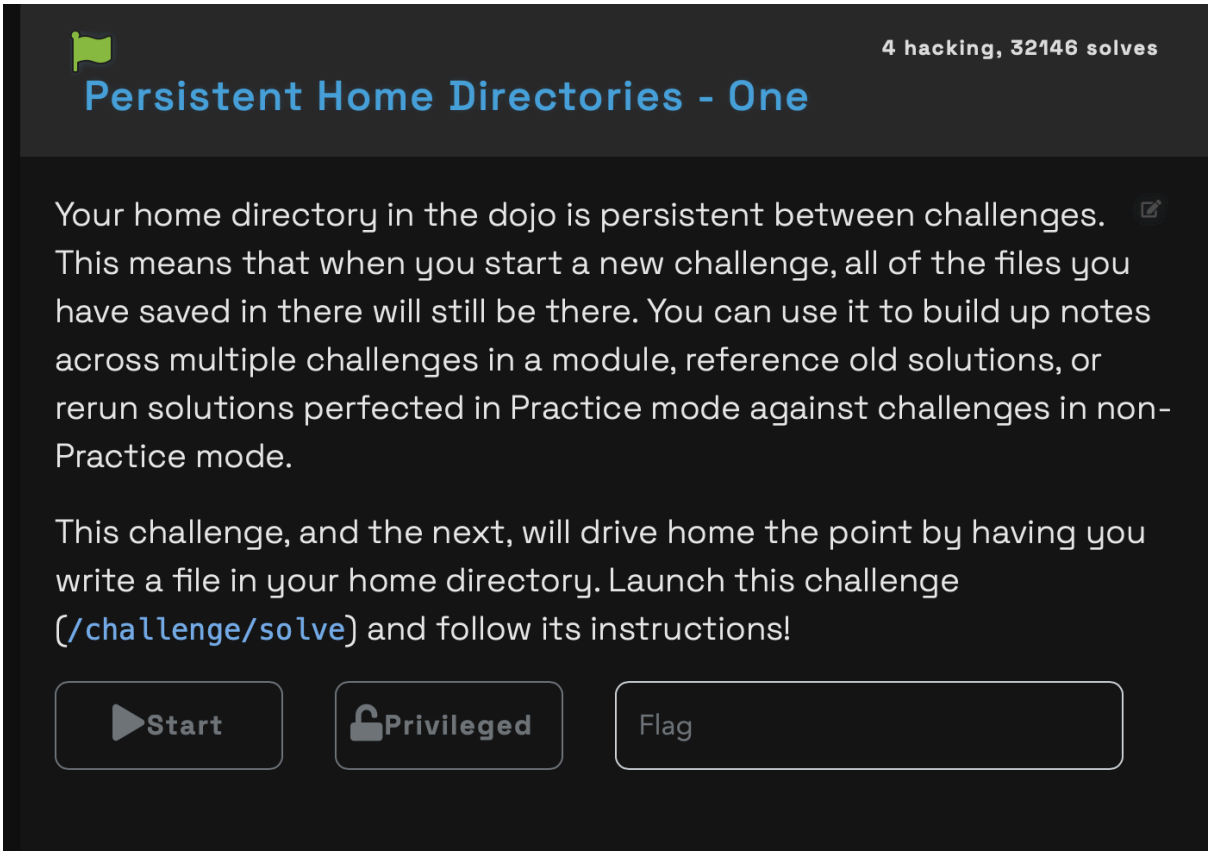
You never *need* Privileged mode to solve a challenge, except for this challenge, because it is designed to expose you to Privileged mode. This challenge has a `/challenge/secret` file that is only readable by root, but it doesn't change between Privileged mode and normal mode. To solve this challenge:

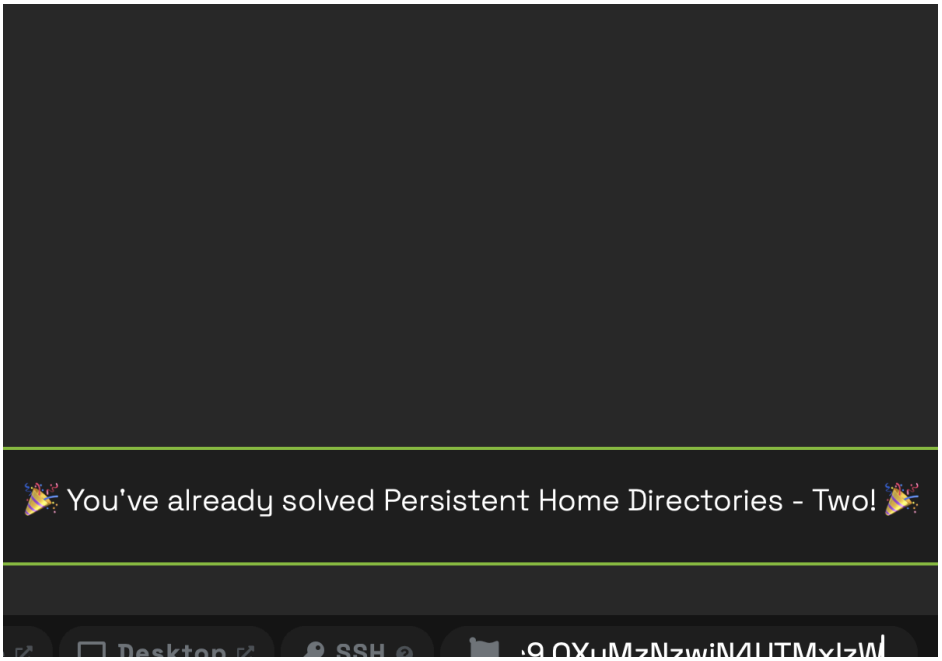
- Launch the challenge in Privileged mode.
- Read the `/challenge/secret` file.
- Relaunch the challenge in normal mode (using Start).
- Provide the secret when `/challenge/solve` asks for it.

🎉 You've already solved Persistent Home Directories - One! 🎉

```
hacker@welcome~persistent-home-directories-one:~$ /challenge/solve
                  .===
                 / __)        _
                 (  ||_.''.  {_}
      ____        | =/ \   /' :
   WELCOME       /\_~/() \__.'       ____
      ---- TO   |_    \   //  |''''`     |-'8,
         __    _ :  |_ '-[]___/   '.....\--.O
       THE   {_}'' .'\ //  |':````
        DOJO  '...'   /\\_/    `,
                     //|\ '._.'
            snd     // //

The file is present and correct! In the next challenge, you will see that
the file stays around! For now, here is the flag for this challenge:
pwn.college{Mzg6G4DQNdHzl5gtUxPB9ApOYdt.QXxMzNzwiN4UTMxIzW}
hacker@welcome~persistent-home-directories-one:~$
```


4 hacking, 32146 solves
Persistent Home Directories - One
Your home directory in the dojo is persistent between challenges. This means that when you start a new challenge, all of the files you have saved in there will still be there. You can use it to build up notes across multiple challenges in a module, reference old solutions, or rerun solutions perfected in Practice mode against challenges in non-Practice mode.
This challenge, and the next, will drive home the point by having you write a file in your home directory. Launch this challenge (/challenge/solve) and follow its instructions!
Start
Privileged
Flag


You've already solved Persistent Home Directories - Two!
Desktop
SSH